DuoVox

User Guide

Real-time transcription & translation • Windows 10 & 11

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1. Welcome

DuoVox transcribes speech in real time and translates it on the fly, so two people who don't share a language can follow a live, two-way conversation on a single Windows PC. It is built for interpreters, clinics, classrooms, support desks, businesses and families.

As each person speaks, DuoVox shows a live transcript of what was said and, alongside it, a running translation. It can caption a call or video playing on your computer, or your own microphone. It can also subtitle a media file after the fact, and translate whole documents.

This guide covers everything from your first session to the built-in tools, with screenshots from the real app alongside the text. Use the clickable Contents page (or your PDF reader's bookmarks panel) to jump to any section.

2. Installation & First Run

- **Microsoft Store**: one-click install, automatic updates, signed by Microsoft. Find it from duovox.net.

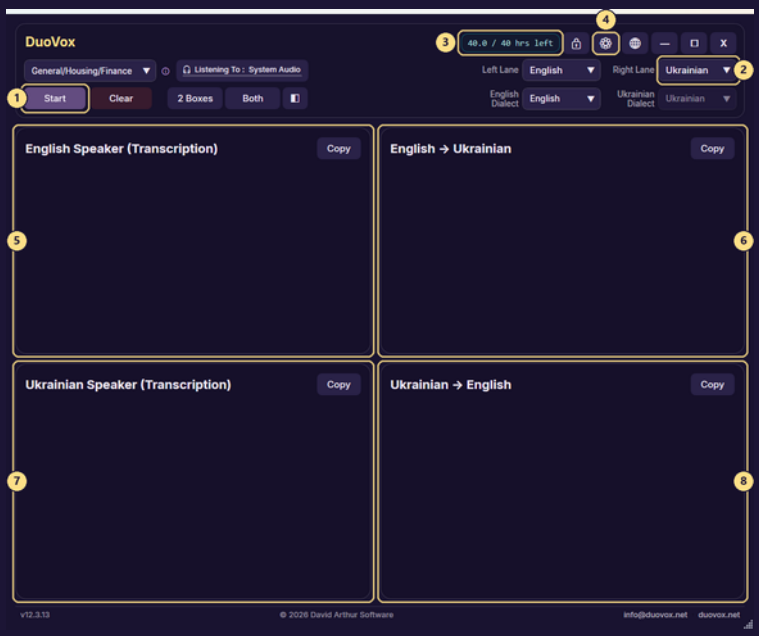
On first launch DuoVox shows the **Terms of Use** and asks you to accept them before the main window opens; this happens once, and again only if the terms change. The interface starts in your Windows display language when DuoVox offers it, and in English otherwise; you can switch it to any of the supported languages at any time from the globe icon in the toolbar.

The first time the main window opens, a card in the caption area helps you choose what to caption: sound from this PC, such as a call or a video, or the microphone, for people in the room. It goes away once you press **Start**.

> ***Tip:*** *DuoVox works straight away on the Free plan with on-device engines: no account or internet connection required to get started.*

3. A Live Conversation

Set your audio source, then press **Start** (or Ctrl+Alt+S). DuoVox begins listening and filling the caption panels with the transcript and, alongside it, the translation. Press **Stop** to end the session.



The main window, ready to start an English–Ukrainian conversation in all four panes.

1. Start / Stop
2. Target-language selector
3. Hours remaining
4. Menu
5. Primary speaker transcript
6. Primary translation
7. Other speaker transcript
8. Other translation

Choosing the audio source

The toolbar shows what DuoVox is currently listening to (for example “Listening To: System Audio”); the thin green bar under it moves while sound is coming in. Click that button to cycle through the four sources:

- **System Audio**: captions a call, meeting or video playing on your PC (Teams, Zoom, YouTube, etc.).
- **PC / Desk Mic**: captions people speaking in the room, through the microphone built into your laptop or a microphone sitting on the desk.
- **Headset Mic**: captions your own voice through a headset microphone worn close to the mouth.
- **System + Mic**: captions both at once – your PC’s sound and your microphone together, for example a call on your PC and the people in the room with you.
- If you see a *"no audio"* message, switch the source so it matches where the sound is actually coming from.

> ***Tip:*** *The last two settings describe how far the microphone is from the speaker, not which device is used.* ***PC / Desk Mic*** *tunes DuoVox for a more distant microphone picking up a room;* ***Headset Mic*** *tunes it for a microphone close to the mouth. Choose whichever matches your situation – your laptop’s built-in microphone is covered by* ***PC / Desk Mic****.*

> ***Tip:*** *With* ***System + Mic****, a headset keeps your PC’s sound out of the microphone. When two people talk at the same time, the louder voice is the one captioned – it works best when people take turns.*

Which device DuoVox actually records from is a separate choice, made in the menu under **Audio → Audio input device**. The list follows the source you picked: on **PC / Desk Mic**, **Headset Mic** or **System + Mic** it lists your microphones, headed by **(Default microphone)** (on **System + Mic** the PC sound always comes from your default playback device); on **System Audio** it lists playback devices, headed by **(Default – System audio)**. Leave it on the default entry to follow the recording device Windows is set to use, or pick a specific microphone from the list if you have more than one connected.

Primary & target languages

A conversation has two sides, chosen from the two language selectors at the right of the toolbar, each headed with the caption pane it fills. Either side can be any supported language, in either direction – DuoVox does not treat one language as the “main” one. The globe icon is separate: it changes the language of DuoVox's own menus and buttons, not the language of the conversation.

- **2-box mode**: shows one speaker and the translation; flip the direction with a button.
- **4-box mode**: shows both speakers transcribed and translated at once, ideal for a true two-way conversation (as in the screenshot above).

Topic & Dialect (Standard and above)

On the paid plans, three selectors help DuoVox recognise the right words for your conversation. **Topic** sits on the left, above the Start button; the two **Dialect** selectors sit directly beneath the language they belong to, so each column reads downwards: the side, then its language, then its dialect.

- **Topic**: the subject of the conversation (for example General / Housing / Finance, Medical, or Legal). DuoVox favours that field's specialist vocabulary so terms are transcribed more accurately.
- **Dialect** – **one for each side of the conversation**, directly under that side's language and labelled with it, so you might see **English Dialect** under the left language and **Arabic Dialect** under the right. Setting them independently is the point: a London clinic can run British English against Tunisian Arabic in the same session, which a single shared setting could never express.

A dialect changes spelling and word choice to match local usage – British versus American English, for example. Not every language has regional variants; when the one you have chosen does not, its selector is greyed out and a tooltip explains why.

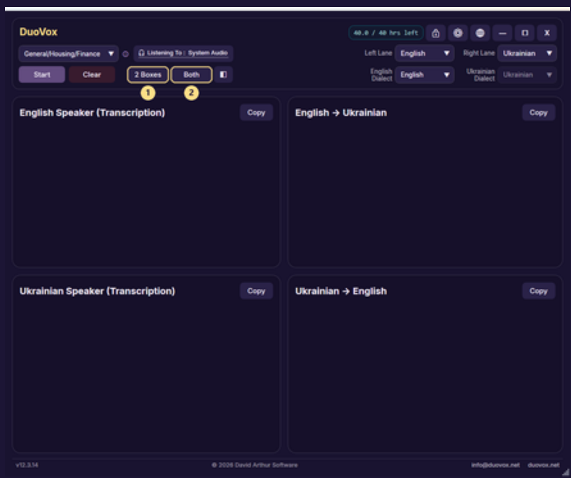
> ***Tip:*** *On the Free plan the Topic and Dialect selectors are visible but greyed out, so you can see what a paid plan adds. On a paid plan the Topic selector is hidden while DuoVox is running offline and the two Dialect selectors grey out – the offline engine does not use them.*

4. Layout & Appearance

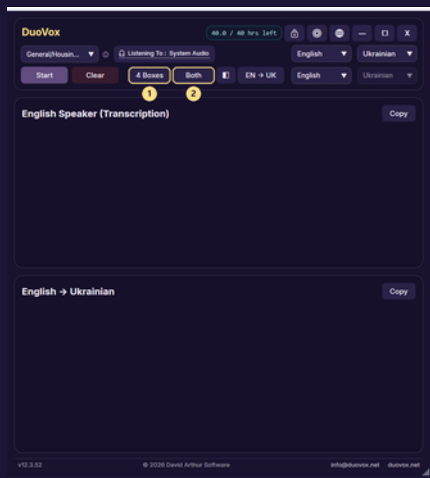
DuoVox's caption area is fully configurable: choose how many panes are visible, whether you see transcripts, translations or both, rearrange which pane sits where, and change the look of the window itself.

Box count and display mode

Two independent toolbar buttons control what the caption area shows. The **4 Boxes / 2 Boxes** button (**1**, Ctrl+Alt+R) sets how many panes are visible, and its label always shows the count you will switch *to* – so it reads “2 Boxes” while you are currently in 4-box view, and “4 Boxes” while you are in 2-box view. The button beside it cycles the display mode through **Both** → **Transcribe** → **Translate** (**2**), and its label shows whichever mode is *currently* active.



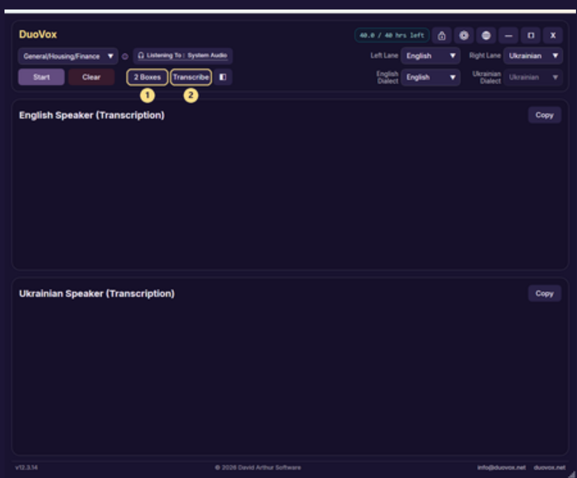
Both, 4 Boxes (the default): every transcript and translation visible at once.



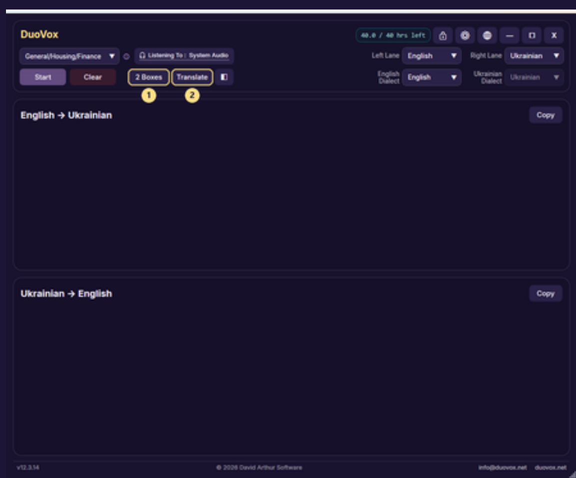
2 Boxes: one speaker's transcript and its translation only, in a narrower window.

Switching to 2 Boxes also narrows the window itself and collapses the language-pair display to a compact form (for example “EN → UK”) so it still fits – handy for keeping DuoVox open beside other work rather than as a full-width panel.

The display-mode button hides whichever half you don't need: **Transcribe** shows only the transcript box(es) and hides every translation; **Translate** does the reverse, showing only the translation box(es).



Transcribe only: transcripts shown, translations hidden.

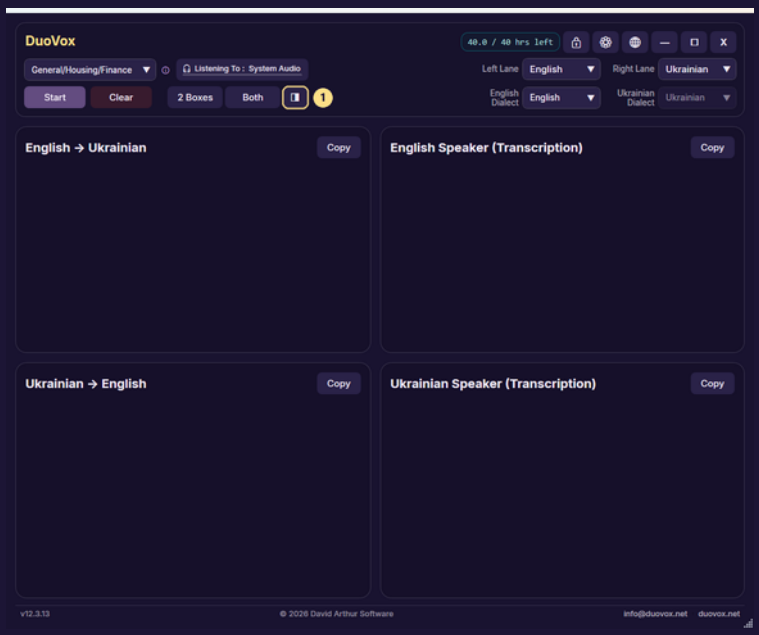


Translate only: translations shown, transcripts hidden.

> ***Tip:*** *2 Boxes combined with Transcribe-only or Translate-only is the most compact layout DuoVox offers: a single narrow pane following just one side of a conversation, so it sits comfortably beside other work instead of taking up the full window.*

Pane arrangement

Panes can also be rearranged, for example placing a speaker's transcript directly beside its translation instead of underneath it.

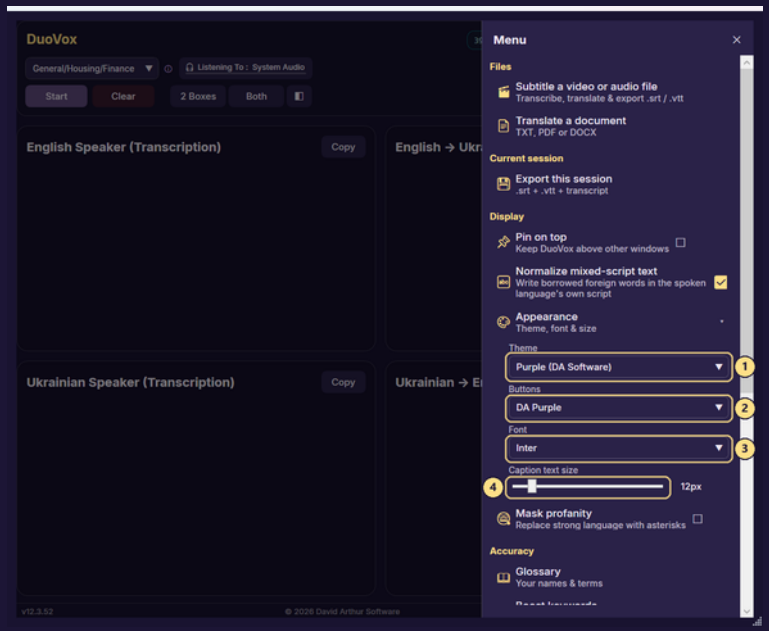


The arrangement button cycles three layouts: stacked, transcripts on the left, or translations on the left, as here.

1 Pane arrangement button

Appearance

Open the menu (gear icon, top-right), then **Display > Appearance** to change how DuoVox looks.



The Appearance panel: pick a Theme, a Button style, and the caption Font and text size. Your choices are remembered between sessions.

1 Theme
2 Buttons – the button style
3 Font – the caption font
4 Caption text size

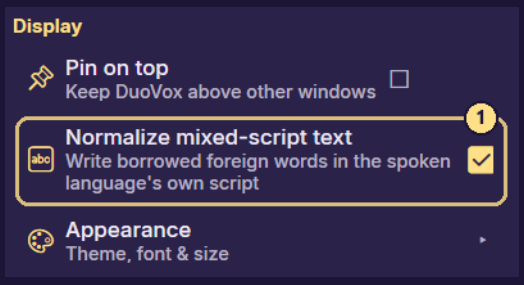
- **Pin** keeps the DuoVox window always on top of other apps (Ctrl+Alt+T).
- **Clear** resets the captions and the subtitle clock (Ctrl+Alt+C).

Normalize mixed-script text

People often drop an English word into a sentence in their own language – and when they do, it is usually written back in English letters, in the middle of a sentence that is otherwise in its own alphabet. The line still reads correctly, but it looks untidy:

- Heard as: "У мене appointment о третій"
- Tidied to: "У мене епойнтмент о третій"

The word is not translated or changed – it is simply spelled in the alphabet of the language being spoken, so the whole line reads in one script. Names and brands (Microsoft, iPhone, NASA) are deliberately left as they are, because that is how people expect to see them.



The setting sits in the menu under Display. The box at the right-hand end of each row shows whether it is on: ticked here for Normalize mixed-script text, empty for Pin on top just above it.

1 Normalize mixed-script text – a ticked box means it is on

- It is found under **Display > Normalize mixed-script text** on a Standard or Professional plan, where it is **already switched on**. Unlike Topic and Dialect, the row is not shown at all on the Free plan.
- The box at the right of the menu row is ticked when it is on and empty when it is off. Select the row to change it.
- It needs an internet connection and a Standard or Professional plan, so it does not run on the Free plan or while DuoVox is working offline.
- It only affects lines that genuinely mix two alphabets, so most conversations never trigger it. The line appears as heard first, then tidies itself a moment later.

Mask profanity

Captions are often on show to more than the person reading them – a waiting room, a classroom, a shared screen in a meeting. **Mask profanity** replaces strong language with asterisks, so the line still reads naturally without putting the words themselves on screen.

- It is found under **Display > Mask profanity**, and starts **switched off**.
- It works on **every plan**, including Free and while DuoVox is running offline – unlike Normalize mixed-script text above, which needs a connection and a paid plan.
- Masking is applied as each line is produced, so it carries through everywhere the words would otherwise appear: the caption on screen, the translation beside it, and any file you export.
- Only whole words are masked, so ordinary place names, surnames and medical terms are not starred out by accident. Chinese and Japanese are matched differently, because they are written without spaces between words.
- The word lists are deliberately conservative and cover the strongest terms in each language. A word that slips through is easier to live with than an ordinary one wrongly hidden.

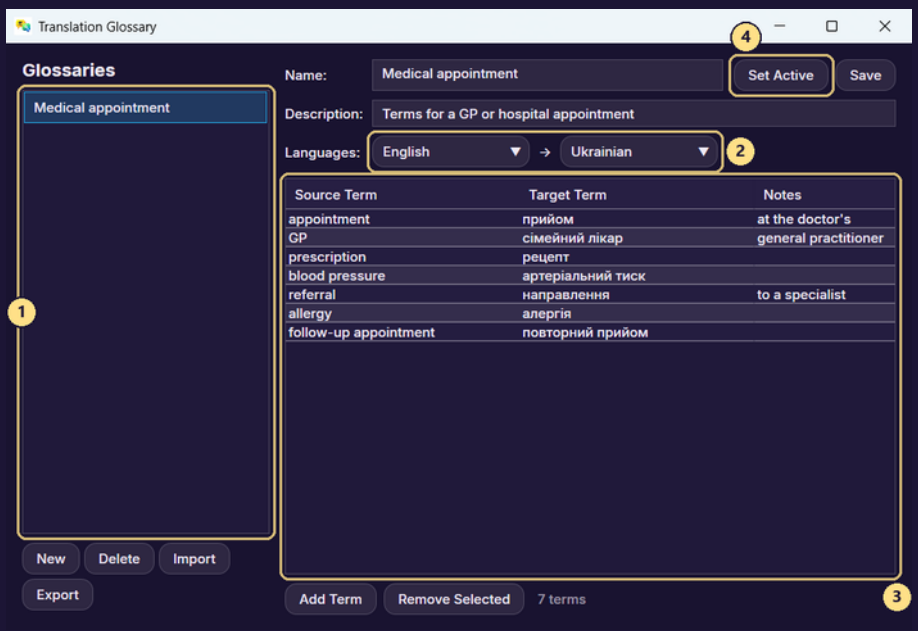
Show sounds

The on-device captions used on the Free plan sometimes notice sounds that are not speech, such as music or applause. **Show sounds** shows them as short labels in square brackets – for example **[music]** – which can help if you are deaf or hard of hearing.

- It is found under **Display > Show sounds**, and starts **switched off**, so captions normally show only the words people say.
- It affects the on-device captions used on the Free plan and whenever DuoVox is running offline.
- The labels are the speech engine's best guess at what it heard, so they are not always accurate.

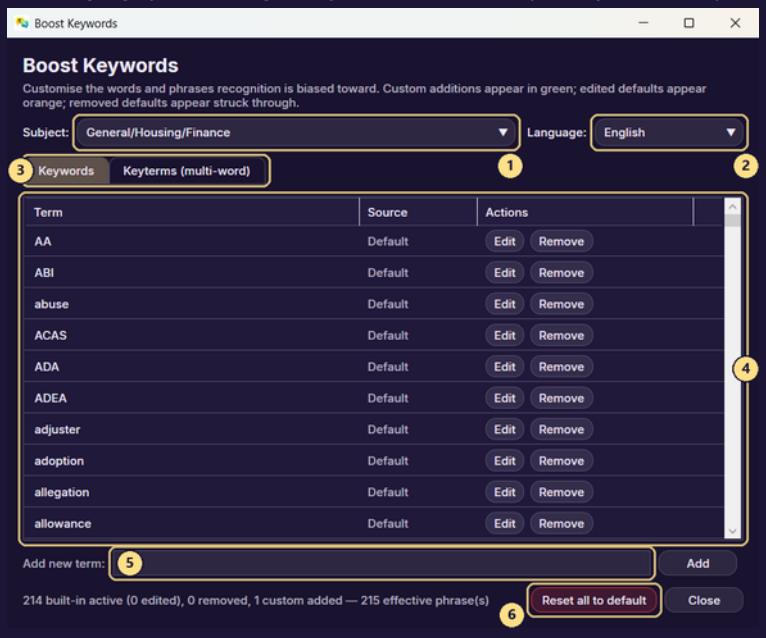
5. Accuracy Tools (Professional)

Open the menu's **Accuracy** group to teach DuoVox the specialist vocabulary of your conversation (names, medical or legal terms, acronyms and jargon) so they come through correctly instead of being misheard.



Translation Glossary, with a demo "Medical appointment" profile: exact translations you supply override the automatic ones.

1 Glossary list (saved profiles)
2 Language pair for this glossary
3 Term table (source, target, notes)
4 Set Active (use in your session)



Boost Keywords: a list of words and phrases DuoVox should listen for more closely.

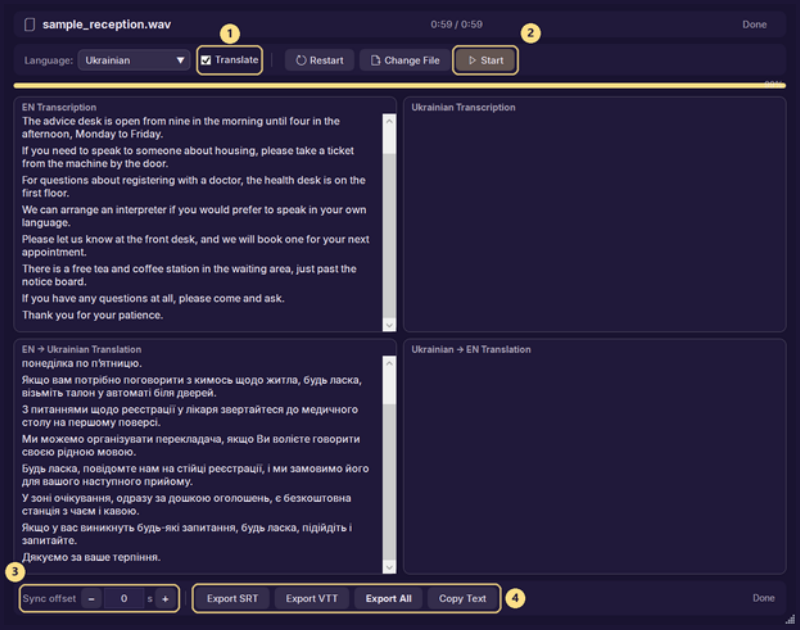
1 Subject
2 Language
3 Keywords / Keyterms tabs
4 Term list
5 Add a new term
6 Reset all to default

> ***Tip:*** *Both tools are Professional features. Build a profile once for a recurring topic (a regular client, a course, a clinic) and reuse it every time.*

6. Working with Files

Subtitle a video or audio file (Professional)

Open the menu's **Files** group and choose **Subtitle a video or audio file** (the clapperboard icon) to transcribe, and optionally translate, an existing recording rather than a live source. A standard Windows file chooser opens. Pick the recording and DuoVox first shows how long it is and how much of your monthly allowance is left – subtitling a file uses your included hours, just as a live session does. Confirm, and the subtitle window opens, shown below.



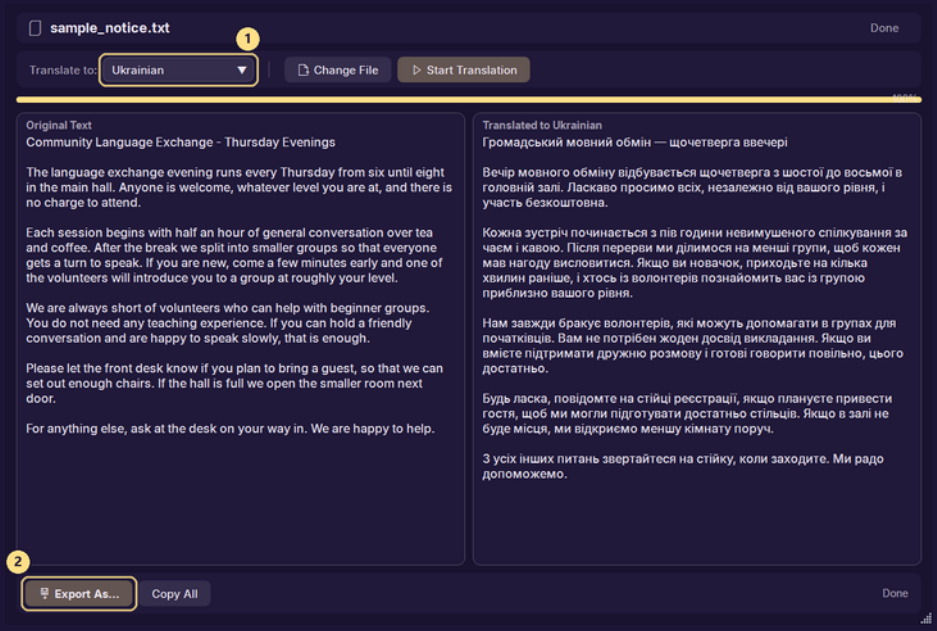
The subtitle window. Minus pulls subtitles earlier if they lag behind the audio; plus delays them.

1 Translate on / off
2 Start
3 Sync offset
4 Export and copy buttons

> ***Tip:*** *A small, fixed start-shift between the audio and the generated subtitles is normal (recognition takes a moment to catch up); the Sync offset corrects for it in one step instead of re-timing every line by hand.*

Translate a document (Standard and above)

Choose **Translate a document** from the same **Files** group to translate a whole TXT, PDF or DOCX file, rather than a spoken conversation. A file chooser opens for you to pick the document. The document window opens with the text loaded; choose your target language and press **Start Translation**. Once it finishes, the original and translated text appear side by side, as shown below.



Document translation complete: original and Ukrainian translation shown side by side.

1 Target language **2** Export As

7. Exporting Your Session

The menu's **Current session** group holds **Export this session** (Ctrl+Alt+E), which saves the live conversation you just ran as subtitles (.srt, plus .vtt for browsers and streaming tools) and a plain-text transcript log (.txt). Exporting is a **Professional** feature.

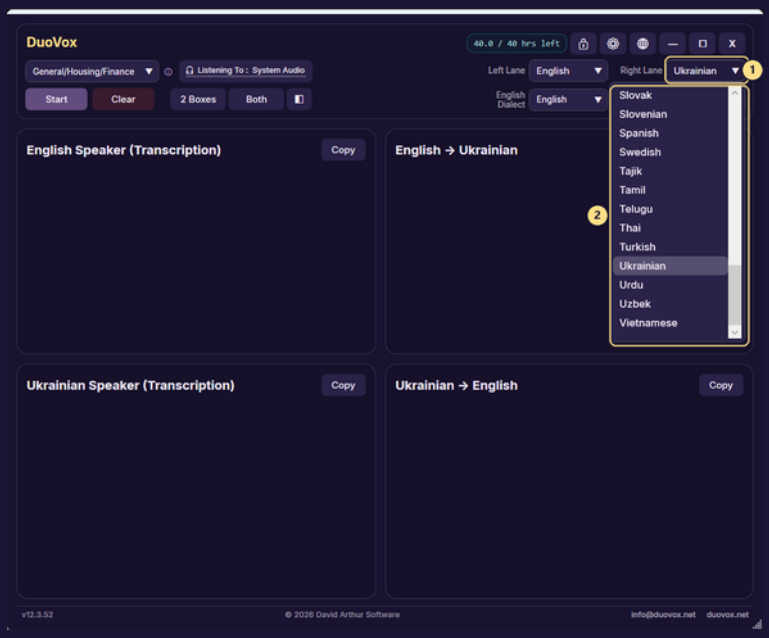
Exports are saved to **Documents\CaptionOverlay\Exports**. Move anything you want to keep for the long term: DuoVox tidies that folder for you, clearing exports older than 90 days.

This is different from subtitling a file, described above: **Export this session** saves the conversation you have been running live in DuoVox, while **Subtitle a video or audio file** processes a separate recording you already have on disk.

Each caption panel has its own **Copy** button in its header, on every plan. It copies that panel's text to the clipboard without saving a file, for pasting straight into another app – copy the panels you want one at a time, or use **Export this session** to save them all at once.

8. Languages & Language Packs

DuoVox offers 49 languages: 43 are captioned on Professional, 33 on Standard, and 30 work offline on Free. Either side of a conversation can use any language your plan captions.



The target-language dropdown open, scrolled to the end of the long list of languages DuoVox supports.

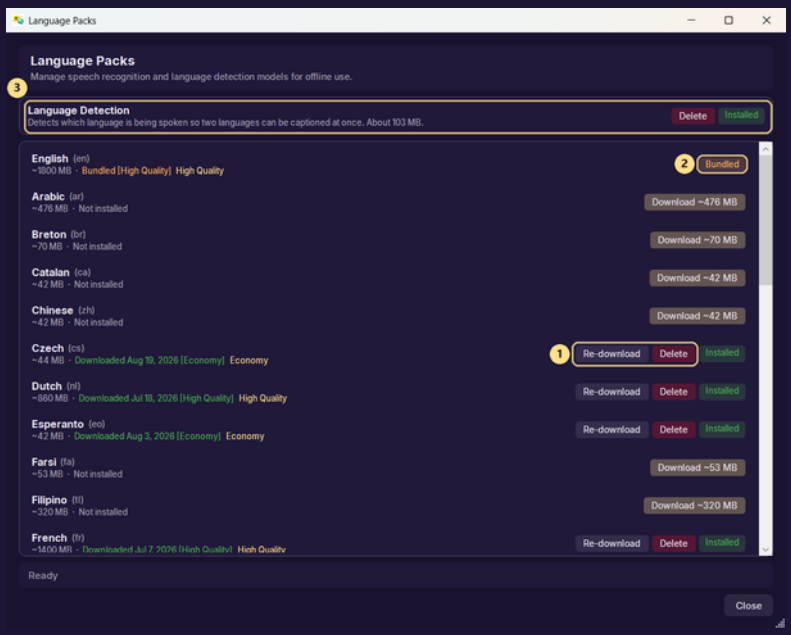
1 Target-language selector **2** The full language list

Not every language works the same way on every plan, so DuoVox tells you before a session rather than after. If you pick a language your plan cannot caption, a short notice appears naming the language and what it would need – for example that it cannot be captioned offline and needs Standard or Professional, or that a language is available on Professional only. Some languages can be translated *into* even when speech in that language cannot be captioned, and the notice says so rather than leaving you to guess.

The same notice appears when you start a session with a language pair you saved earlier, so a pair that no longer suits your plan cannot sit there silently producing nothing. A full per-plan list of every language is published at duovox.net/languages.

> ***Tip:*** *Some languages have no instant draft: the words appear a moment later as finished sentences instead of building up live. DuoVox says so when you pick one – nothing is missing, it simply arrives in one piece.*

Open the menu's **Settings & advanced** group and choose **Download Languages** to manage the on-device speech models DuoVox uses for the Free plan's fully offline mode, and as an automatic fallback if your internet connection drops during a paid session.



Language Packs: download and manage the on-device models used for offline recognition.

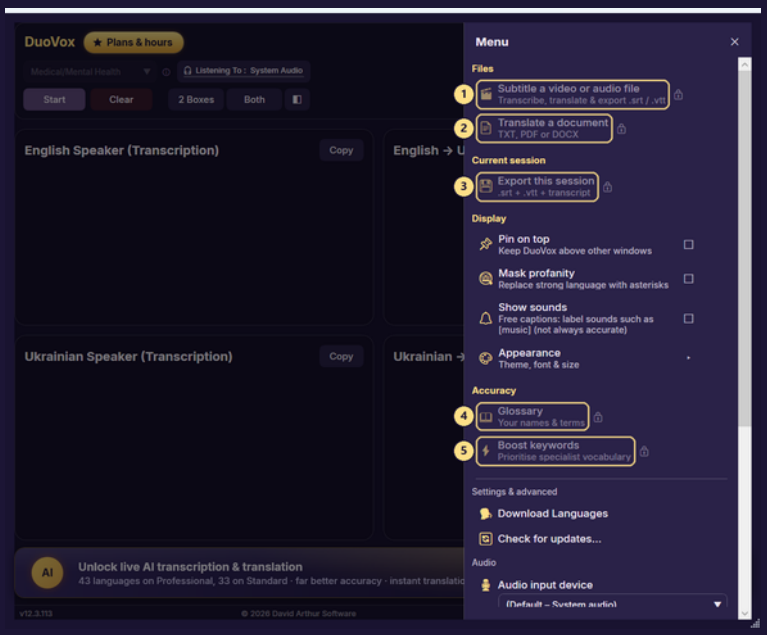
1 Re-download or delete a pack
2 Install status
3 Language detection model

9. Plans & What Each Unlocks

DuoVox offers a Free plan and paid plans, and it is designed never to leave you stuck:

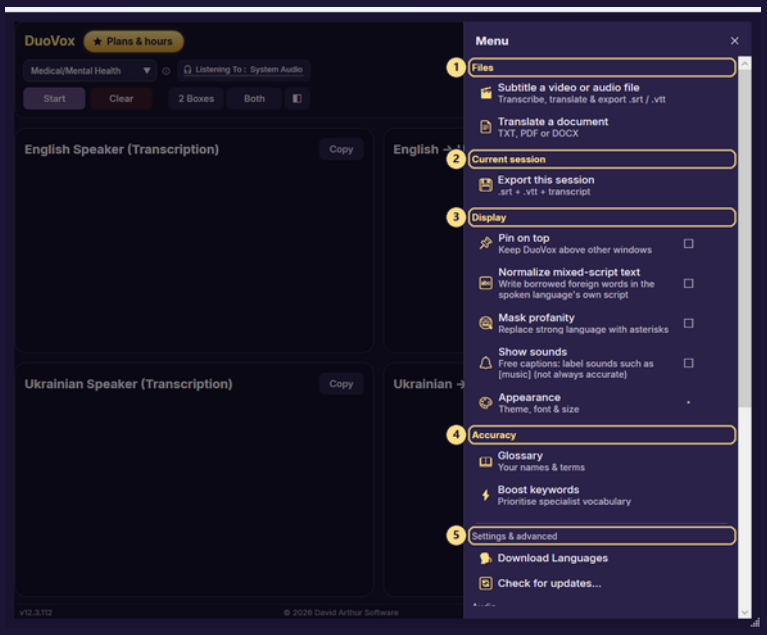
- **Free**: transcription *and* translation, running entirely on your own PC. No internet connection and no account needed, unlimited use, but lower accuracy than the paid plans and none of the paid-only features below. Download the language packs you need first (see section 8).
- **Standard**: online AI speech recognition and translation, a set number of hours included each month – a large accuracy gain over the offline engine.
- **Professional**: our most accurate speech recognition and translation, the widest language coverage, and every feature in this guide.

If your internet drops, DuoVox keeps working in free offline on-device mode and returns to your plan's AI by itself as soon as the connection is back. If instead you reach your monthly hours, it stays in free offline mode for the rest of that session; hours you buy apply from the next one. Nothing is ever bought without you confirming it in the Microsoft Store. The header shows your remaining hours on a paid plan, and when you reach a cap you simply choose: buy more hours (**Pay As You Go**), continue offline, or end the session. If you switch on **One-tap top-up** (in the menu, under **Settings & advanced**) and set your own monthly limit, DuoVox offers the purchase straight away instead, and stops offering once you reach that limit.



The menu drawer on the Free plan: all five items above are padlocked. Translate a document needs Standard; the other four need Professional.

1 Subtitle a video or audio file
2 Translate a document
3 Export this session
4 Glossary
5 Boost keywords



The same drawer on Professional: every group is unlocked.

1 Files
2 Current session
3 Display
4 Accuracy
5 Settings & advanced

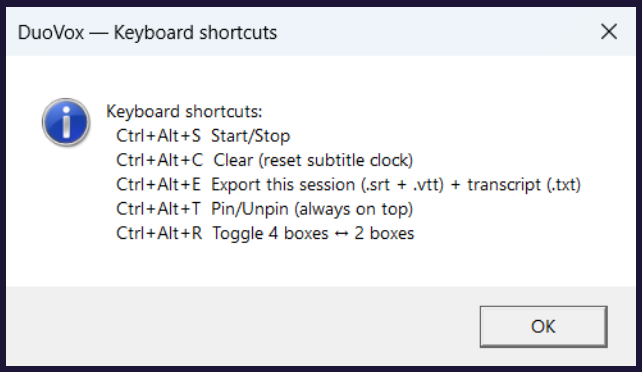
Clicking a locked feature shows this poster: the feature, the plan that unlocks it, and what upgrading adds.

What each tier unlocks

- **Every plan, including Free**: Mask profanity and Show sounds.
- **Standard and above**: Translate a document, Normalize mixed-script text, the Topic and Dialect selectors, and the hours-remaining indicator in the header.
- **Professional**: Glossary, Boost Keywords, Subtitle a video or audio file, Export this session, and Private Mode.

Private Mode (the padlock button in the toolbar, Professional) clears the captions as soon as you stop and turns off copy and export for that session.

10. Keyboard Shortcuts



The Keyboard Shortcuts panel, reachable from the menu.

- **Ctrl+Alt+S**: Start / Stop
- **Ctrl+Alt+C**: Clear (reset subtitle clock)
- **Ctrl+Alt+E**: Export this session (.srt and .vtt subtitles, plus a .txt transcript)
- **Ctrl+Alt+T**: Pin / Unpin (always on top)
- **Ctrl+Alt+R**: Toggle 4 boxes / 2 boxes

11. Help & Support

Scroll to the bottom of the menu, below the dividing line, and you will find everything for when you need a hand:

- **Keyboard shortcuts**: the same list printed in section 10.
- **User guide**: opens this guide again at any time.
- **Help**: short explanations of each part of the app, without leaving DuoVox.
- **Video tutorials**: short videos on YouTube, starting with a first conversation step by step, then one for each part of DuoVox. It opens in your web browser.
- **More help online**: the Help page on duovox.net, with the videos, this guide online, answers to common problems and how to contact us. It opens in your web browser.
- **Report a problem**: tells us something has gone wrong – see below.
- **Send a suggestion**: an idea, or a feature you would like to see. Every one is read.
- **About**: shows your installed version and your device ID – useful information to have to hand if you contact support, or if you write to us about your data.

Report a problem and **Send a suggestion** are also on the **About** page, below the contact address and your device ID.

Reporting a problem

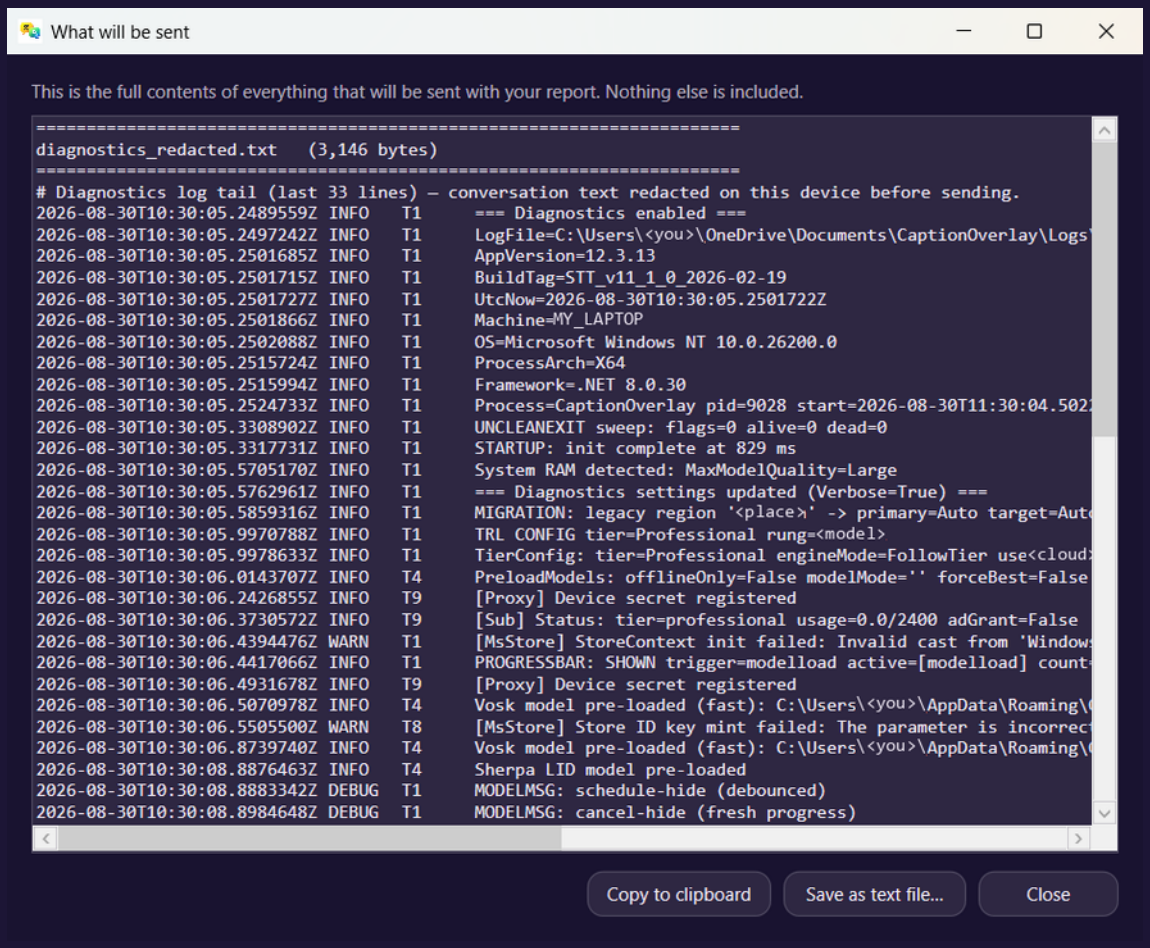
Describe what happened if you can – though you can send the report without writing anything, because the useful technical detail is gathered for you. You can add your email address if you would like a reply; leave it blank and the report is anonymous.

- **What is sent**: your description, your email address if you gave one, a technical log with all conversation text removed, the app version, your plan, and error counters.
- **What is never sent**: your conversations, translations, audio, contacts or files. DuoVox removes the words from the technical log on your own PC, before anything is sent.
- **You can check first**: **View exactly what will be sent** shows the complete contents of the report on screen, with buttons to copy it or save it as a text file. If you would rather not send it, press Cancel and nothing leaves your PC.

Two tick-boxes let you choose how much to include – the technical log, and your settings (your two languages, the audio source and device, whether you were offline, and your display options). Both are ticked to begin with, and neither contains anything you said. Untick either one if you prefer.

The Report a problem window. Nothing is sent until you press Send report.

1. What happened (optional)
2. Your email address (optional)
3. What to include
4. What is sent and what is never sent
5. Check the contents first

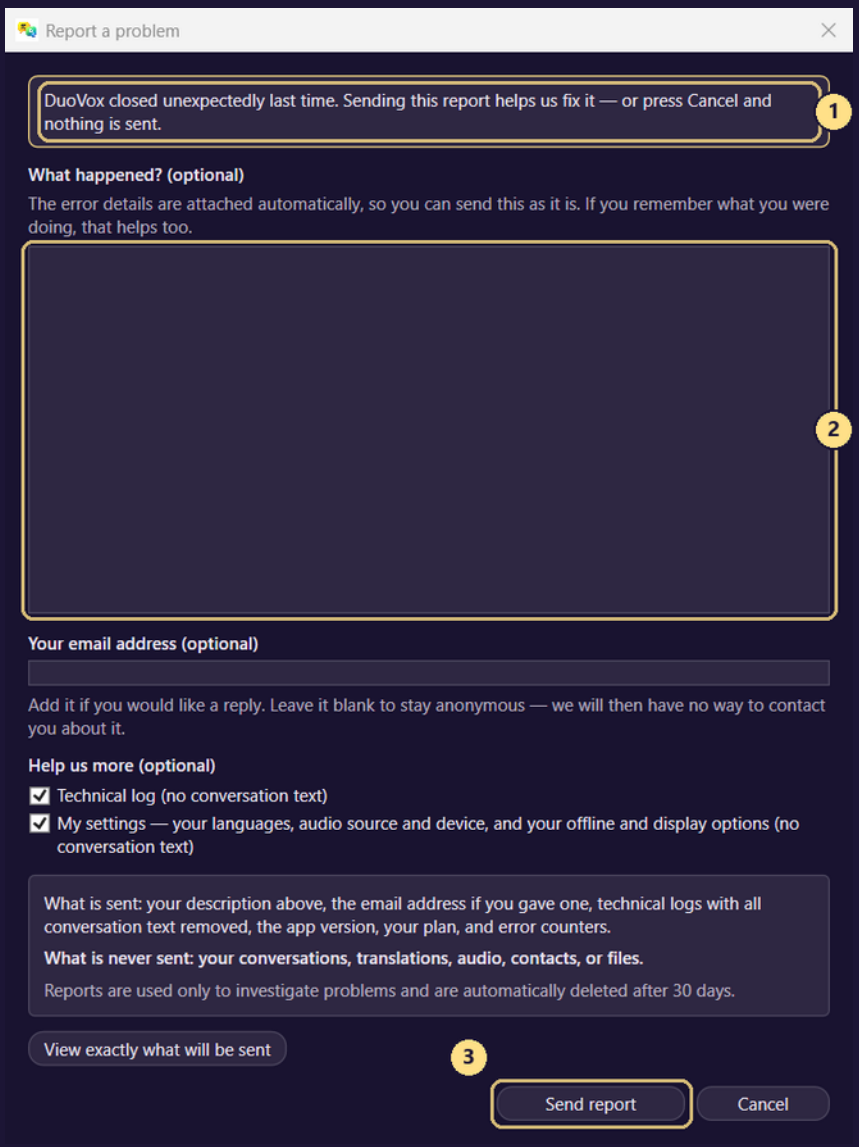


View exactly what will be sent shows every file in the report, in full, with buttons to copy it or save it as a text file.

> ***Tip:*** *Reports are kept for 30 days and used only to investigate problems. Suggestions are kept for up to a year so they can be considered for future releases.*

If DuoVox closes unexpectedly

If DuoVox stops responding or closes on its own, it makes a note of what happened. The next time you start it, it offers to send that as a report – the error details are attached for you, so you can simply press **Send report**, or press **Cancel** if you would rather not. Nothing is sent unless you choose to send it, and you are only asked once per incident.

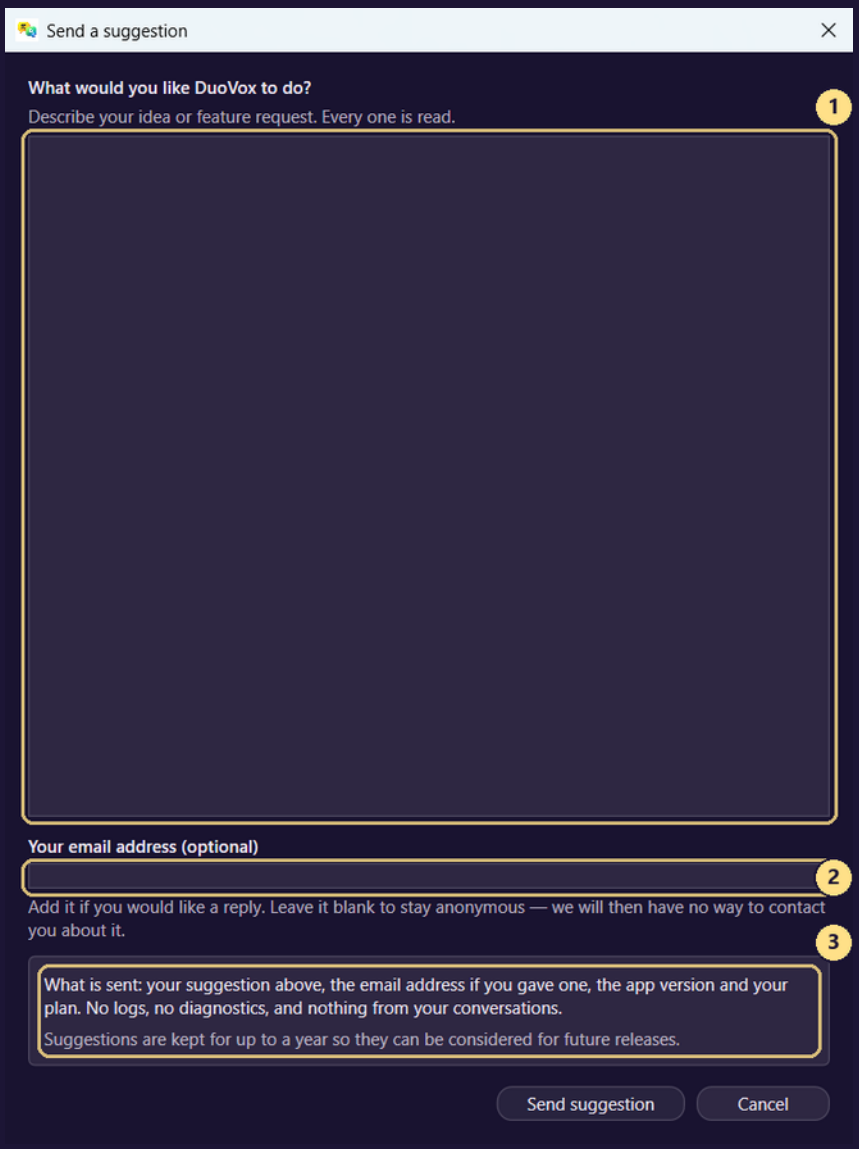


What DuoVox shows the next time you start it after an unexpected closure.

1. Why you are seeing this
2. Add anything you remember (optional)
3. Send, or press Cancel

Sending a suggestion

Send a suggestion is for an idea or a feature you would like to see, rather than something going wrong. It sends what you write, your email address if you give one, and the app version and plan – no logs, no diagnostics and nothing from your conversations.

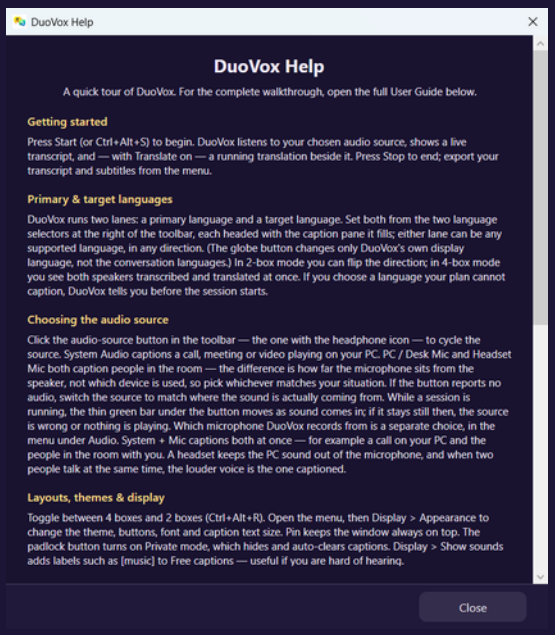


The Send a suggestion window.

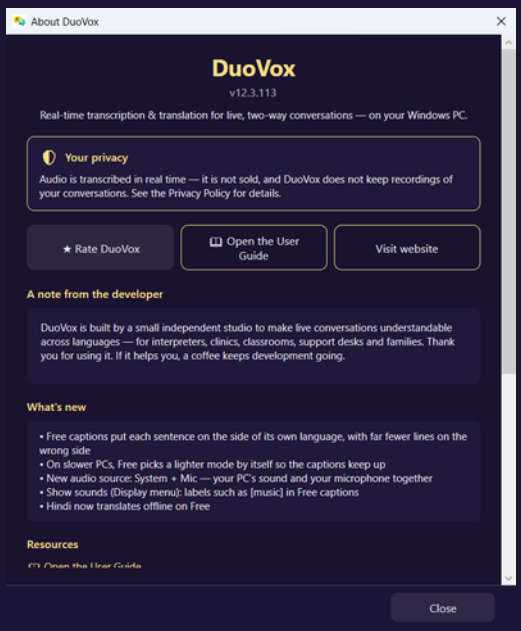
1 Your idea

2 Your email address (optional)

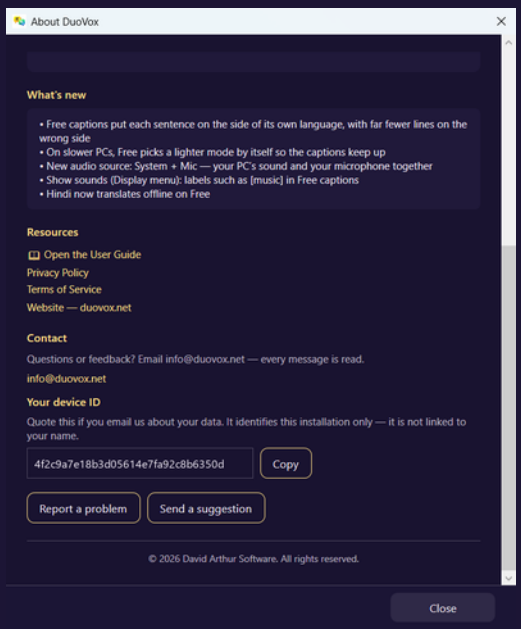
3 What is sent, and how long it is kept



The Help panel.



The About panel, showing your installed version.



Scroll down in About for your device ID, links to the privacy policy and terms, and the buttons for reporting a problem or sending a suggestion.

Questions or feedback are always welcome: email **info@duovox.net** and every message is read. You can also visit duovox.net for the latest news, the privacy policy and the terms of service.

If DuoVox helps you, an optional “Buy me a coffee” keeps a small independent studio going. Thank you for using DuoVox.